

Olawunmi Mutiu Fakorede

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics | University of Utah

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Research Interests

Development Economics | Labor Economics | Law & Economics | Political Economy | Economic History

Education

University of Utah, Salt Lake City, UT — *Ph.D. in Economics*. Fields: Development, Labor, Health, Law & Economics, Economic History. Dissertation Committee: Fernando Wilson (Chair), Bruce Wydick, Sarah Small, Megan Reynolds, and Francisco Perez.

University of San Francisco, San Francisco, CA — *M.Sc. in International & Development Economics (2022)*. GPA: 3.96/4.00; Valedictorian; Jesuit Foundation Research Grant Recipient. Thesis: *How Worthy is Thy Skin tone? A Socioeconomic Analysis in Nigeria*.

University of Agriculture Abeokuta, Nigeria — *B.Sc. in Agricultural Economics (First Class Honors, 2016)*.

Job Market Paper

The Long-Run Effects of Colonial Educational Legacy: Language, Migration, and Human Capital in Nigeria. Using a spatial regression discontinuity across historical colonial boundaries, this paper estimates the causal effects of English-language educational gatekeeping on human capital formation and high-skilled emigration. Results challenge “brain drain as gain” narratives by showing persistent colonial-era distortions in talent allocation and global labor market inequality.

Working Papers & Research in Progress

How Worthy is Thy Skin tone? A Socioeconomic Analysis in Nigeria — under journal submission.

The Policy Ecology of Care in Illinois: Leveraging Novel Labor Market Generosity, Caregiver Vulnerability & Legal Mapping Indices.

Unfit or Unfair? A Legislative Review of Illinois Mental Health Statutes and the Best Interest of the Child Standard in Custody Determinations — working paper.

Therapeutic Justice or Procedural Ambiguity? Mental Health Courts in Illinois — ongoing project.

Gendered Crises: How Economic Shocks and Pandemics Shape Mental Health in Nigeria (2000–2023).

Labor Market Institution Generosity and Birth Outcomes in the U.S. — with Megan Reynolds.

Fueling Inflation: PMS Pump Price Passthrough to Staple Food Prices in Nigeria — draft in progress.

Conference Presentations

Western States Graduate Workshop in Economics, 2024 — *Colonial Educational Legacy*.

Western States Graduate Workshop in Economics, 2023 — *Skin Tone and Socioeconomic Inequality*.

Pacific Conference for Development Economics (PACDEV), 2022 — *Skin Tone and Socioeconomic Inequality*.

University of Utah Graduate Seminar Series, 2023–2025.

Teaching Experience

University of Utah — Teaching Assistant, *Principles of Microeconomics* (Spring 2022, Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2024).

University of Utah — Instructor, *Introduction to Health Economics* (Fall 2025).

Research Experience

Research Assistant, University of Utah (2023–present). With Prof. Fernando Wilson: health administrative data, BRFSS datasets, and policy evaluation. With Prof. Megan Reynolds: labor market institutions and demographic analysis. With Prof. Sarah Small: gendered and racial caregiving analysis.

Research Assistant, University of San Francisco (2021–2022). National Longitudinal Survey (NLSY79) data analysis and development projects with faculty including Alessandra Cassar and Bruce Wydick.

Principal Investigator, Jesuit Foundation Grant (2020–2022). Fieldwork in Nigeria on colorism and discrimination.

Professional Experience (Selected)

Risk & Compliance Consultant, African Export-Import Bank (2020–present).

Analyst, Office of the Provost, University of San Francisco (2022–2023).

Strategy Consultant, Wood Mackenzie / PCG Consulting (2018–2020).

Policy & Program Consultant, The UN World Food Programme (2016–2018).

Managing Partner, Bridges & Barriers Advisory Service LLC, Nigeria (2018–present).

Risk Management Manager, KPMG (2008–2014).

Awards & Fellowships

Rasmussen Endowment Fund Scholarship, University of Utah (2024).

Graduate Valedictorian & Commencement Speaker, USF (2022).

Jacques Arthur Best Graduate Economics Student Award, USF (2022).

NABE Diversity Scholar, National Association for Business Economics (2021).

Jesuit Foundation Research Grant, University of San Francisco (2021).

UNAAB Scholar Award (2006).

Technical Skills

Econometrics & Statistics: Stata (Advanced), R (Advanced), MATLAB (Intermediate), GIS, Dedoose.

Methods: Causal Inference, Regression Discontinuity, IV, Difference-in-Differences, Survey Design, Text-as-Data.

Languages: English (Fluent), Yoruba (Fluent), Arabic (Conversational).

Professional Affiliations

American Economic Association (AEA) · African Finance & Economics Association · National Association for Business Economics (NABE) · Pacific Development Economics Conference (PACDEV)